

Nicholas Reardon

Gameplay and Systems Programmer

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Summary

Computer science student building modular gameplay systems in Unreal Engine 5 on Lyra, focused on combat, encounters, persistence, and designer-facing workflows.

Skills

Languages: C++, C#, Python, GDScript, Java

Engines and Frameworks: Unreal Engine 5, Unity, Godot

Unreal Engine: Gameplay Ability System, Game Feature Plugins, Lyra, Enhanced Input, Behavior Trees, EQS, UMG

Gameplay and Systems: Data-driven Design, Modular Combat, Encounter Systems, Spawn Systems, Save and Persistence

Tooling: Git, Diversion, JetBrains Rider, Visual Studio

Projects

Tethered

Sept 2025 – present

- Architected a modular Lyra-based gameplay framework using Game Feature plugin isolation to keep combat, game modes, and content decoupled while iterating on an arena-mode vertical slice.
- Designed a world-level event bus on the GameState Ability System Component to coordinate encounter, spawn, and travel systems at runtime without coupling individual components.
- Built a seamless-travel subsystem that snapshots and reconstructs player and world state across level transitions, preserving GAS attributes, equipment, and run upgrades through GameState teardown.
- Implemented a pluggable save backend behind an interface, isolating disk I/O from runtime state and leaving a clean extension point for future server-backed persistence.

Alien Survivors

Sept 2024 – Dec 2024

- Built an enemy spawning director with spawn pacing, cap management, and optional object pooling for performance under high enemy counts.
- Implemented rarity-weighted enemy selection with per-type parameters and runtime tuning hooks for spawn rate and movement speed.

Last Oasis

2025 game jam

- Built a nested state-machine character controller with ground, air, wall-slide, slam, destroy, and death states; coyote time; variable-height jumping; wall jumps; input buffering; spike grace frames; and tile-data-driven slippery surfaces.
- Built an aimable launch ability with aim, fire, and cancel states, a live guide line, and on-screen control prompts.
- Created an editor-time tile-to-scene tool that swaps tiles for scene instances keyed by tile custom data while preserving flip, transpose, and rotation values.

A Totally Normal Bike Ride

3-day game jam

- Built a two-body physics character using a wheel and rider rigidbody joined by a pin joint, with torque-based locomotion and separate ground and air balance tuning.
- Implemented a charge-and-release variable jump with compression, impulse scaling, contact-based ground state, and rolling average-speed feedback.

Experience

Electronics Support Technician, Cheapest iPhone Repair – Laguna Niguel and Irvine, CA

June 2023 – July 2024

- Diagnosed and repaired unfamiliar devices through structured troubleshooting, fault isolation, and verification testing.

Education

California State University, Fullerton, Bachelor of Science in Computer Science – Fullerton, CA

Dec 2026

Saddleback College, Associate of Science in Computer Science – Mission Viejo, CA

May 2024